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COMMENTARY: Library district begins magazine adoption campaign

George Williams, Latah County Library System

As I sit trying to write this brief column about why you should support the Latah County Library District's Adopt-A-Magazine program this year, I'm reminded of just how, shall we say, repetitive, it is to listen to the people on PBS every year saying "Please support Idaho Public Television."

I'm also reminded that even after I call in a pledge, I still end up complaining to my wife that "This Old House" is off its schedule for three Sundays in a row. Maybe I'm not the ideal person to be writing this column. But maybe I can go over the same kinds of points that the good people at PBS cover every year when they do their thing.

This year the Latah County Library District would like to subscribe to 232 print magazines and newspapers. This will cost the library more than \$8,000. By adopting a magazine, you'll be helping us provide periodicals that cover a wide range of subject areas.

Certainly, the library district gets most of its budget from local tax dollars. But like PBS, we need help. With seven library locations to support, only about 12 percent of the library tax dollars raised in Latah County actually pay for new materials like book, movies, and magazines. We appreciate donations. A big part of the library's mission involves helping the public stay informed, and with

newspapers like Boise's The Idaho Statesman costing hundreds of dollars per year, it's tough to do our job well without some extra help.

Adopting a magazine is a simple and effective way of helping the library. Most of the magazines available for adoption cost less than \$30 per year. To participate, go into your local Latah County library and ask to see the list of magazines available for adoption. Once you've selected a title, there's a short form to fill out. You can ask that the donation be made in your own name, or in honor of a friend, a relative, a community group, or even a business. Whoever you select will be acknowledged as that magazine's "parent" by the library that owns the magazine.

As a bonus, our Adopt-A-Magazine campaign will not alter your regularly scheduled viewing of "This Old House" or "Antiques Road Show" in any way. Unless you happen to check out some magazines while adopting one, and read them instead of watching your favorite show.

George Williams is the access services manager for the Latah County Library District.

